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RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE
2013

Preparing the Research Instruments Section

Overview

- **Quantitative research methods** (surveys, experiments)

- **Qualitative research methods** (interviews, focus group discussion)

Purpose of the instrument section

- is to give readers a detailed explanation of how the key variables were conceptualized and measured in the study.

- the readers can evaluate the study by evaluating whether the instruments provided an adequate measure of the variables of interest (or research questions/ hypothesis).

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Quantitative research

Studies that use survey questionnaires

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Description of the instruments (3 ways):

1. **Adopted** - If the instrument was adopted verbatim from an original instrument, present the following:

- Who developed the measure? with specific citation information (include the reference in the References section)
- A brief explanation of the construct that it was designed to measure (or the operational definition).
- How participants will respond to the items or questions (open-ended or close-ended: Likert scale, yes/no, frequency, etc.)
- How the variable was scored or coding system (e.g., higher scores would mean; yes = 1 or no = 0)
- Indicate psychometric properties (i.e. Cronbach's alpha) from published studies that used the same scale.
- Permission to use the scale (attach in the Appendix)

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Sample (Adopted Instrument)

Depression Anxiety and Stress Scale (DASS-21). the DASS-21 is adopted to assess participants' mental health state (Lovibond & Lovibond, 1995). Permission to use the instrument was obtained from the original developers (See appendix C). The 21-item self-reported instrument contains three subscales, namely: depression, anxiety, and stress (see appendix D). Each of the subscale contains 7 items, divided into subscales with similar content. The depression scale assesses dysphoria, hopelessness, devaluation of life, self-deprecation, lack of interest / involvement, anhedonia and inertia. The anxiety scale assesses autonomic arousal, skeletal muscle effects, situational anxiety, and subjective experience of anxious affect. The stress scale is sensitive to levels of chronic nonspecific arousal. It assesses difficulty relaxing, nervous arousal, and being easily upset / agitated, irritable / over-reactive and impatient. Scores for depression, anxiety and stress are calculated by summing the scores for the relevant items. Participants will respond to each item on a 4-point Likert scale (0 = *did not apply to me at all*; 3 = *applied to me very much or most of the time*), with higher scores indicating greater levels of depression and anxiety symptoms. Previous studies have confirmed the validity of the three-factor structure of the DASS-21 (Habibi et al., 2017), with inter-item reliability estimates ranging from $\alpha = .89$ to $\alpha = .95$ for depression subscale and $\alpha = .85$ to $\alpha = .90$ for anxiety subscale (e.g., Adetunji & Ademuyiwa, 2019; Widyana & Safitri, 2020). Importantly, the scale has been used to assess depression, anxiety, and stress symptoms using Filipino samples (Labrague, 2014).

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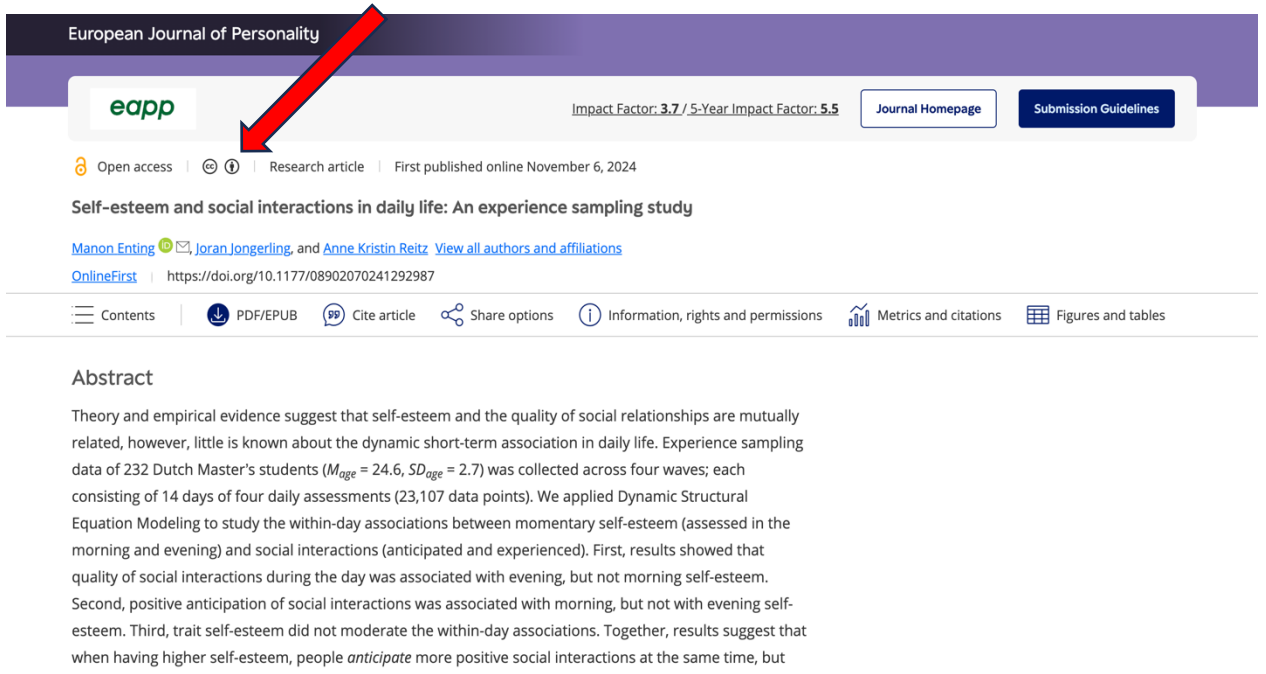
Permission to use published (adopted) scale

- Researchers are required to attach either of the two:
  - Screenshot of email sent to the proponents of the published scale asking for permission to use the scale questionnaire
  - Screenshot of the webpage/journal article which clearly shows the license (i.e. Creative Commons License) of the article or scale questionnaire. The screenshot should show that the scale questionnaire can be used for non-commercial and/or educational purposes *(see example on Where to find the license?)*

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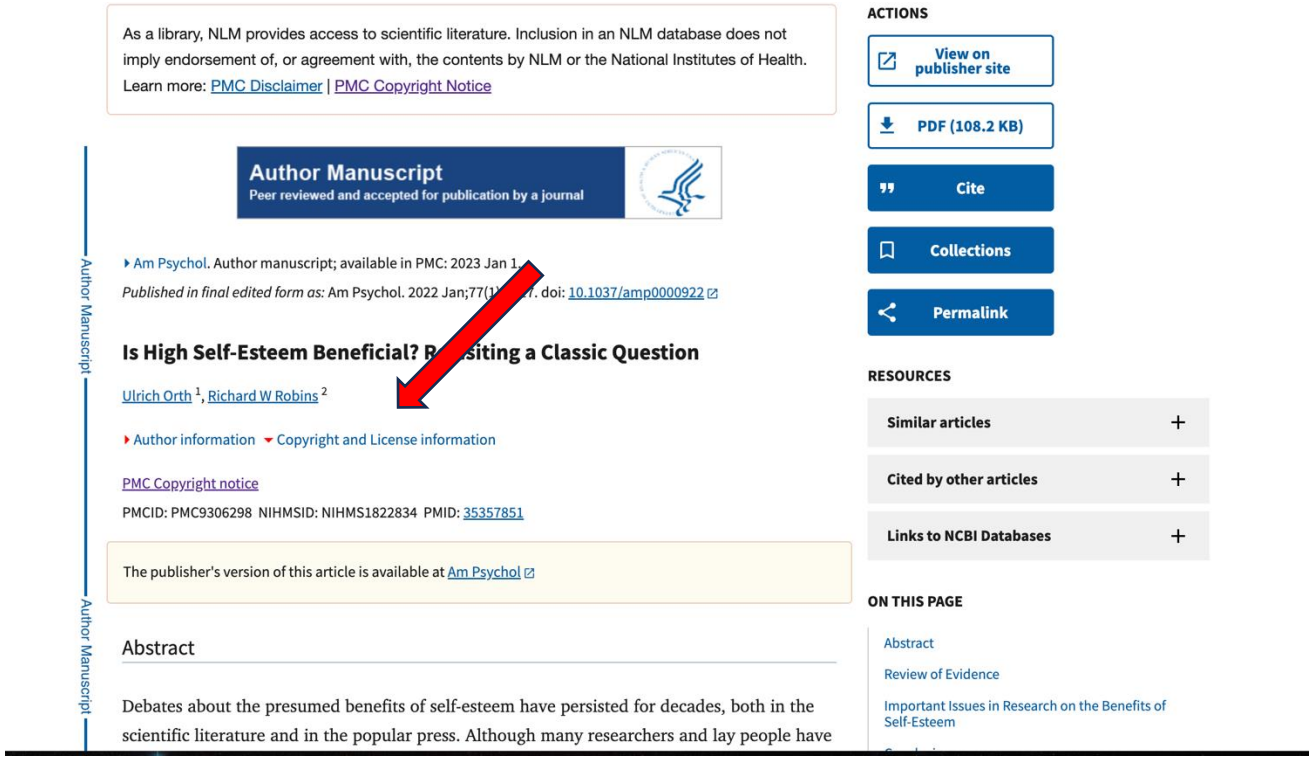
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Is High Self-Esteem Beneficial? R[illegible]siting a Classic Question

Ulrich Orth [1], Richard W Robins [2]

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Abstract

Debates about the presumed benefits of self-esteem have persisted for decades, both in the scientific literature and in the popular press. Although many researchers and lay people have

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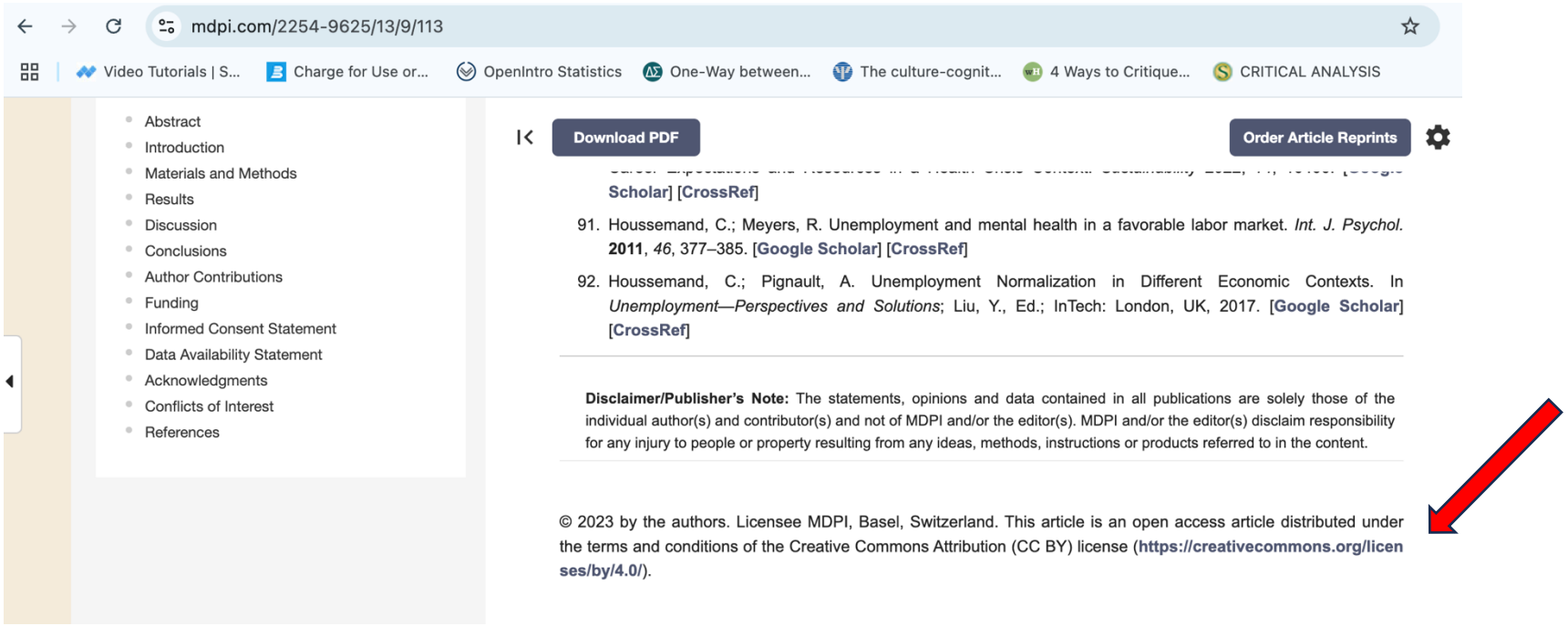
Abstract

Review of Evidence

Important Issues in Research on the Benefits of Self-Esteem

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Description of the instruments (3 ways):

2. Adapted - If the instrument was adapted because substantial changes were made from the original:

- Who developed the measure? with specific citation information (include the reference in the References section)
- A brief explanation of the construct that it was designed to measure (or the operational definition).
- How participants will respond to the items or questions (open-ended or close-ended: Likert scale, yes/no, frequency, etc.)
- Exactly what was changed on the instrument, how the changes were made, and why
- How the revision was judged to be a valid amendment (content validity via expert judgement, internal reliability/psychometric properties via pilot testing),
- Permission to use the scale (attach in the Appendix)

Sample (Adapted Instrument)

Psychological Capital. PsyCap was measured at baseline (pre-intervention) and one week after the intervention (post-intervention) using the 24-item PsyCap Questionnaire (PCQ; Luthans et al. 2007). Permission was obtained to use the PCQ from www.mindgarden.com. Responses used the typical 6-point Likert-type scale ranging from 1 = "*strongly disagree*" to 6 = "*strongly agree.*" Because the scale was originally designed for to assess the psychological capital of working adults, all items were slightly modified to fit the participants (i.e., adolescent students) and context of this study (e.g., school setting). Sample items are: "*If I should find myself in a jam in my studies/projects, I could think of many ways to get out of it*" and "*I always look on the bright side of things regarding my studies.*" The internal consistency reliability of the modified and translated PCQ and its subscales were assessed. In the pilot test phase (n = 100), the internal consistency of the instrument yielded a Cronbach's alpha of 0.93 (a = 0.79 for hope, a = 0.86 for self-efficacy, a = 0.84 for optimism, and a = 0.86 for resilience).

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Description of the instruments:

- **Psychometric properties related to the reliability of instruments** (e.g., Cronbach's alpha) – Adapted/modified scales should be tested for reliability. A pilot/pre-test should be done.

➢ *An example of a psychometric testing score is the Cronbach's alpha is a measure of internal consistency, that is, how closely related a set of items are as a group. It is considered to be a measure of scale reliability.*

Cronbach's alpha	Internal consistency
$\alpha \geq 0.9$	Excellent
$0.9 > \alpha \geq 0.8$	Good
$0.8 > \alpha \geq 0.7$	Acceptable
$0.7 > \alpha \geq 0.6$	Questionable
$0.6 > \alpha \geq 0.5$	Poor
$0.5 > \alpha$	Unacceptable

(Coulacoglou & Saklofske, 2017)

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Permission to use and modify scale (for adapted/modified scales)

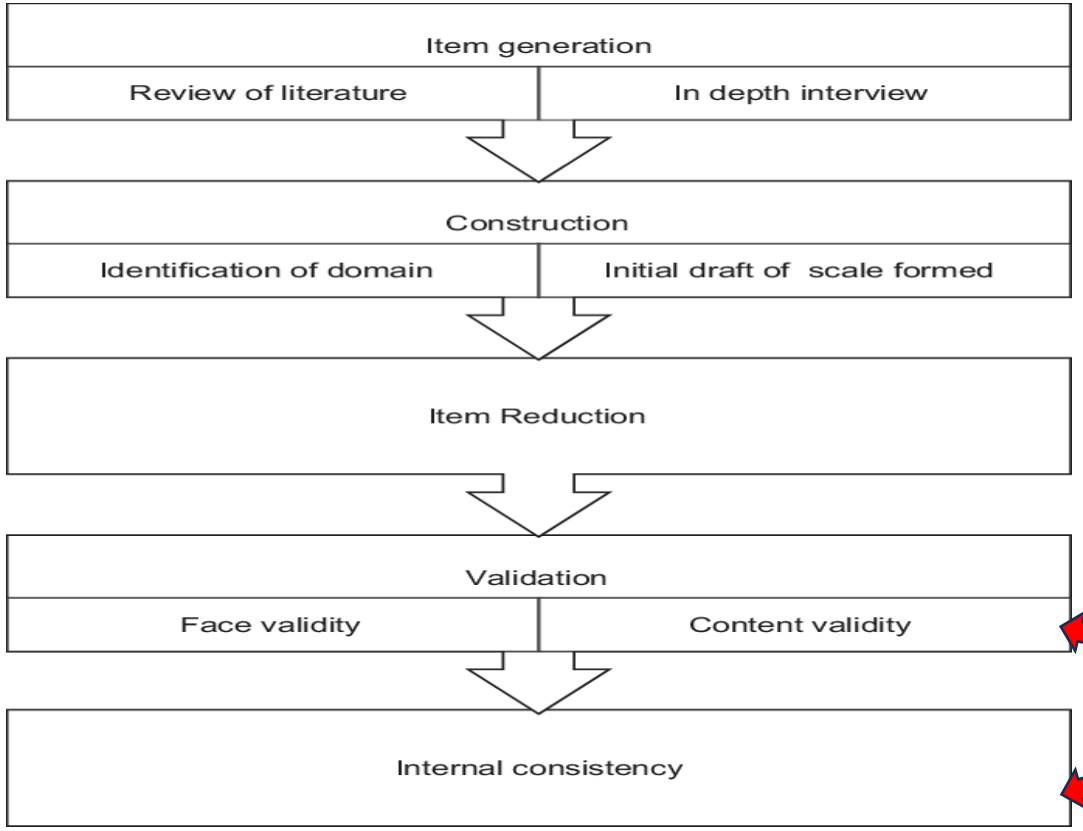
- Researchers are required to attach either of the two:
  - Screenshot of email sent to the proponents of the published scale asking for permission to use AND modify the scale
  - Screenshot of the webpage/journal article which clearly shows the license (i.e. Creative Commons License) of the article or scale questionnaire. The screenshot should show that the scale questionnaire can be **used and modified** for non-commercial and/or educational purposes

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Description of the instruments (3 ways):

3. New Instrument or Researcher-developed - If a new quantitative instrument was created for the purpose of the study, report:

- The procedure and resources used to develop the measure



See next slide(s)

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Researcher-developed: content validity

- Provide or attach certification that shows the researcher-developed scale was content validated by experts.

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Researcher-developed: Internal consistency

- **Psychometric properties related to the reliability of instruments** (e.g., Cronbach's alpha) – Researcher-developed scales should be tested for reliability. A pilot/pre-test should be done.

➢ *An example of a psychometric testing score is the Cronbach's alpha is a measure of internal consistency, that is, how closely related a set of items are as a group. It is considered to be a measure of scale reliability.*

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$0.5 > \alpha$	Unacceptable

(Coulacoglou & Saklofske, 2017)

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Sample (researcher-developed)

Objective SES. Three commonly used objective indicators were used to assess participants' SES (Education, Income, and Housing). Educational attainment was assessed and coded into eight categories (0 = *None; 1 = elementary undergraduate*; 2 = *elementary graduate;* 3 = *high school undergraduate*; 4 = *high school graduate;* 5 = *college undergraduate*; 6 = *college graduate;* and 7 = *post baccalaureate*).

Income (i.e., monthly income for a family of 5 members) was assessed and coded into seven income clusters based on data from the Philippine Institute for Development Studies (Albert et al., 2018): 1 = *poor* (Less than P10,957 pesos); 2 = *Low-income class* (Between 10,957 and 21,914 pesos); 3 = *Lower middle-income class* (between 21,914 and 43,828 pesos); 4 = *middle income class* (Between 43,828 and 76,669 pesos); 5 = *Upper middle-income class* (Between 76,669 and 131,484 pesos), 6 = *Upper-income class* (Between 131,483 to P219,140 pesos); 7 = *Rich* (219,140 PHP and above).

Housing conditions were assessed based on two characteristics (tenure status of the housing unit and lot, construction materials of roof and outer walls) from the Annual Poverty Indicators Survey (APIS; Philippine Statistics Authority, 2017). First, the tenure status of the housing unit and lot was coded into five categories (1 = *rent-free house and lot without consent of owner*; 2 = *own house, rent-free lot without consent of owner*; 3 = *rent house or room*; 4 = *own house, rent-free lot with consent of owner*; and 5 = *own house and lot*). Second, the construction materials of the roof and outer walls was coded in six categories: (1 = *salvaged/ makeshift materials*; 2 = *mixed but predominantly salvaged materials*; 3 = *mixed but predominantly light materials*; 4 = *light materials*, 5 = *mixed but predominantly strong materials*, and 6 = *strong materials*).

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Quantitative research

Studies that use experiments/interventions

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Experimental Designs

- Provide details of the experimentation
- Content of the specific experimental manipulations/treatments/interventions
- Method of experimental manipulation delivery
- Deliverer/experimenter: who delivered the experimental manipulations
- Exposure quantity and duration: how many sessions, episodes, or events were intended
- Time span (of the entire procedure)
- Experimenter scripts/ Instructions/ Debriefing (in the Appendix)
- Sufficient detail to allow for replication (for future research or validation of the procedure)

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Sample 1.1 (experimental)

Materials and Procedure

The protocol of this research was reviewed and approved by the research ethics committee at the authors' institution. After ethical approval had been granted, permission to conduct the research was sought from the respective authorities of the intervention and control sites. Written informed consent and assent were obtained from the legal guardians and participating adolescents, respectively.

Description of the Intervention. Participants were told they would be participating in a series of career exploration activities. Because the training protocol of the PCI was designed, implemented, and evaluated within an organizational context (Luthans et al., 2010), we modified the content to fit the objectives and context of this research. Drawing on the resource activation theory (Flückiger et al., 2010), the career guidance sessions were designed to activate participants' psychological resources through resource priming (psychoeducational group activities and counseling). For both studies, the first part of each session focused on psychoeducational group activities, and the second part was dedicated to individual counseling. The career guidance sessions ran for four hours and occurred weekly for four weeks. The sessions were facilitated by three guidance counselors specializing in student career development and assisted by seven graduate students pursuing their master's degree training (school counseling and guidance program). Table 1 summarizes the content of the HERO career guidance intervention.

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Sample 1.2 (experimental)

Table 1

Overview of the HERO Career guidance intervention

	Proximal Outcome	Developmental Dimensions	Sample Activities
Week 1	Hope	Goals & pathways Overcoming obstacles	• Career Goal-Setting Games • Career Road Map
Week 2	Self-efficacy	Experiencing Success & Imitating Others Persuasion & Arousal	• Past Successes • Satisfying Achievements
Week 3	Resilience	Building Assets/ Avoiding Risks How to affect the influence Process	• Values Clarification • Meaning Making • Resilience Plan
Week 4	Optimism	Building Confidence Developing Positive Expectancy	• The Best Possible Self • Doors Closed Doors Open

Control conditions. Participants in the pilot study who were randomly assigned to the control condition received their usual career guidance activities (e.g., career talks, and career aptitude and assessments). For the main study, those in the control condition received the usual service (i.e., vocational training). The government-run juvenile justice center is also a transitional living program for youth involved with the juvenile justice system. Similar to MHAP, the center also provides the typical reintegration interventions (e.g., psychological support, educational support, and vocational training) except for a career guidance intervention.

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Sample 2.1 (experimental)

Procedure and materials. At the beginning of the experiment, participants were told that they were participating in a nationwide policy review study conducted by the Philippine Statistics Authority. Participants were randomly assigned to read one of two editorials.

Stability of social stratification manipulation. Two editorials were fabricated to look like pages from the country's leading business newspaper (see Jackson & Esses, 2000, for similar manipulation). In the unstable condition, the editorial focused on presenting fictitious data on the narrowing income gap between the rich and poor. It contained statements such as, 'Recently, the data indicate that the gap between the country's rich and poor is narrowing fast, with low socioeconomic status groups enjoying significantly faster growth in incomes compared to members of the higher socioeconomic status groups.' In the stable condition, the editorial focused on statistics on the widening gap between the rich and the poor (e.g., 'The data indicate that the gap between the country's rich and poor is unchanging, with higher socioeconomic status groups sustaining growth in incomes compared to members of low socioeconomic status groups').

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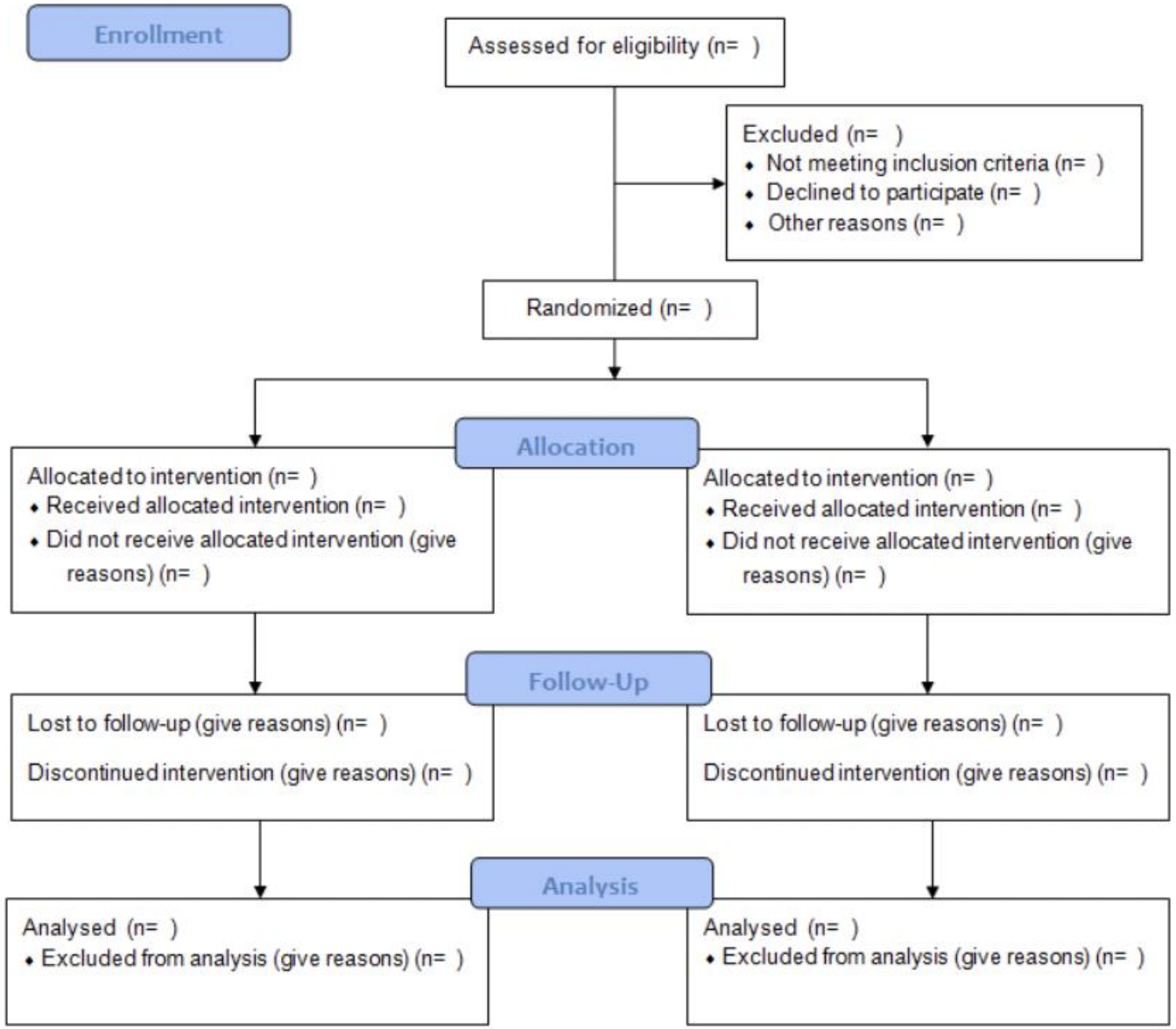
Sample 2.2 (experimental)

Manipulation check. The effectiveness of the perceived stability of the social stratification was assessed by asking the participants' level of agreement with the statement, 'On the basis of the information provided, the income gap between higher and lower socioeconomic groups would remain stable for years to come', on a 7-point scale ranging from 1 (*strongly disagree*) to 7 (*strongly agree*).

Forms of help. The second part of the experiment was an adaption from past research (see Abad-Merino, Newheiser, Dovidio, Tabanero, & González, 2013). Following this, participants were told that they were participating in a national tax policy review regarding budget allocation for the proposed anti-poverty programs. All participants were asked to read four vignettes that described typical social problems faced by low SES groups in the country (i.e., access to college education, livelihood, healthcare, and decent housing). After each scenario, participants were then asked to complete items that measure dependency-oriented and autonomy-oriented help (1 = *strongly disagree* to 5 = *strongly agree*). The items were modified to fit the context of the current study.

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CONSORT 2010 Flow Diagram



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Qualitative Research

Interviews, Focus Group Discussions

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Qualitative Research Methods

- can be written in a chronological or narrative format
- State the form of data to be collected (e.g., interviews, group discussions, recorded observation).
- For interviews, indicate the estimate of the time duration (based on the pilot test of the interview guide)
- Describe questions asked in data collection: content of central questions, form of questions (semi-structured) or prompt questions, and how it was developed (based on the theoretical framework, research methodology or paradigm)
- Report other tools (communication devices, software, recorders, etc.)

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Sample (Qualitative)

Ethical approval was obtained from research ethics committee of the University of San Carlos. The entire data collection process of this study was accomplished via an online interview method using Skype (21). We scheduled the interviews convenient for the participants in order to create a comfortable environment for them to privately express their thoughts and feelings regarding the subject matter. Before the interview began, informed consent was obtained from the participants. To maintain the privacy and confidentiality, we asked permission to record the interview through the use of an audio and screen recorder and assured that all signed informed consent forms, interview recordings, and anonymized transcripts were kept in a secure location (ie, accessible only to the authors of the study). More importantly, we formulated semistructured form of interview questions in accordance with the practical guide of IPA (22), which sought to explore various aspects of the participants' child relinquishment experiences ranging from broad questions such as "Could you describe what happens in a surrogacy agreement?" to more specific matters such as "How do you feel when you handed over the baby to the intended couple?"

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THANK YOU!

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